EPITOME

"The world will ask you who you are, and if you don't know, the world will tell you."

Dr CG Jung

ARCHETYPE FRAMEWORK RESULTS

SALLY-ANN SAMPLE

“All the most powerful ideas in history go back to archetypes.”

Dr CG Jung.

OVERVIEW OF ARCHETYPES AND LEADERSHIP

Archetypes are universal, recurring patterns of behaviour that resonate deeply within human psychology. Originating from the work of the 20th century Swiss psychiatrist, C.G. Jung, these archetypes represent fundamental human motifs that cross cultures, gender, age and time periods. He described them as universal, yet felt by each individual in a unique and personal way.

In the context of leadership development, understanding archetypes can provide powerful insights into how individuals lead, their communication preferences, the ways they interact with peers and inspire others.

Archetypes embody specific strengths, abilities, and potential weaknesses or blind spots that create our individual leadership styles.

They are broad and universal, but each person expresses them in a unique and specific manner. Storytelling is one of the critical skills that leaders need, and understanding how our archetypal profile supports this helps amplify this capability.

Archetypes are flexible and contextual. Understanding them gives a leader the ability to draw on different archetypes depending on situation, context and goals, and to amplify the range she already has.

“Unconscious of your story, you are in its grasp; but with consciousness, an alchemical process begins: The solidity of the complex dissolves and you can open up to the arrival of a new archetype, the birth of a new cycle of life. In the shadow, then, lies our myth and our fate.”

Dr Connie Zweig

THE EPITOME ARCHETYPE FRAMEWORK

Building on the rich history of archetypes, the Epitome Archetype Framework (EAF) offers four female leadership archetypes: the Sovereign, the Empress, the Seductress and the Consort.[1] They are not four types of women, and not four separate selves to move between. They are four dimensions of one woman, all present at once. Every leader carries all four. What differs is which she is currently drawing on, which are waiting in the wings, and which she has quietly set down along the way.

Each archetype is explored through its distinct relationship to power - where that power comes from, how it moves, what amplifies it, and what it costs under pressure. Each carries real gifts and a real shadow, and the shadow is not a flaw to be corrected. It is what the gift becomes under pressure. The assessment reads across twelve dimensions of leadership, and this is where the four become visible in practice. You may lead strongly as one archetype on one dimension and barely register her on another. That variation is not inconsistency. It shows where you already have range, and how the archetypes move depending on situation and context.

Your assessment shows the shape of your four. It is a starting point for reflection rather than a verdict: on the leadership identity you have built, on the archetype you may be leading from by default rather than by choice, and on what becomes available when you deliberately amplify one of the others. The skill this framework builds is range - knowing which to draw on, and when.

The EAF comes out of a three-year research project through Deakin University's Business School, exploring the changing leadership narratives of emerging and seasoned women in Australia and the USA. Merle Singer was a funded researcher with the Center for Applications of Psychological Type, and archetype was the basis of every in-depth conversation with participants. That research, together with her decade-long leadership development practice and a corporate career in Australia's first tech unicorn, produced the framework. **Epitome: Leadership Archetypes for Women** is the companion to this report, and takes each archetype further than these pages can.

1 The new archetype framework is built-on a **three-year global research project** on female leaders under the auspices of Deakin University’s Business School. The research explored the changing face of leadership styles and narratives in emerging women and senior women as they navigate a volatile, uncertain, complex and ambiguous world (VUCA) both in Australia and the USA.

EPITOME ARCHETYPE
Executive Overview

The Sovereign



As a **natural leader**, the Sovereign appreciates clarity of data, logical **argument** and **wisdom** in decision-making. A **calm, analytic**, clear leader with a **strong understanding of systems** and how best to operate within them are some of the qualities she possesses.

The Sovereign possess **personal power** and at her best she is an exceptional **mentor and sponsor** for those around her, appreciating the **importance of teams** in achieving vision and goals.

When this archetype is high, some of the **leadership challenges** that may be embodied include being seen by others as **aloof, intimidating, withering** and hard to get to know.

EPITOME ARCHETYPE
Executive Overview

The Consort



As a highly **networked and connected** leader, the Consort takes her true north from her senior leader and acts as the **power behind the throne**. She is the trusted confidante, valued not only for her talent but for her discretion and her loyalty. She appreciates the importance of well-oiled systems and strong teams to achieve exceptional results.

The Consort's power is not her own, but rather **reflected power** gained from her leader, and the strong engagement she has in the business is amplified by this **power-based relationship.**

When this archetype is high, some of the **leadership challenges** that may be displayed include **passive aggression, rejection sensitivity, and officiousness.**



EPITOME ARCHETYPE
Executive Overview

The Empress



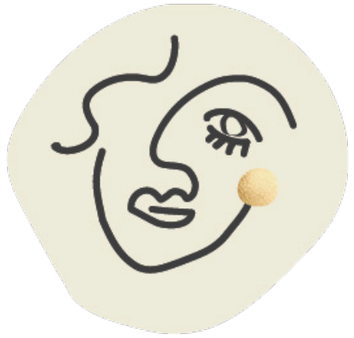
A passionate and creative leader, the Empress takes an instinctual response to data and ensures her decision-making is a mix of **rigor and innate understanding.**

The Empress is a **natural in teams, possessing personal power**, which is amplified dramatically through the teams she works with. She takes pride in mastery of **understanding individual and team dynamic.**

When this archetype is high, some of the **leadership challenges** that may be embodied include being seen by others as **chaotic** under pressure, **emotionally leaky and cliquish**.

EPITOME ARCHETYPE
Executive Overview

The Seductress



A driven and ambitious leader, the Seductress has a **presence** and a **magnetism** that she brings to her leadership style. She will incorporate **data, instinct and clarity** to drive her agenda.

The Seductress not only has **strong personal power**, she intuitively understands where the **power base** is in the organization and will **leverage** these to get things happening.

When this archetype is high, some of the **leadership challenges** that may be displayed include being seen by others as **self-absorbed, overly ambitious, ruthless** and dismissive.

EPITOME ARCHETYPES BY CRITERIA

You tend to lead with the EMPRESS.

The diagram below is the analysis of the assessment you completed.

The legend outlines the colors representing each archetype -

- SOVEREIGN
- CONSORT
- EMPRESS
- SEDUCTRESS

Each assessment question represents a leadership dimension with four statements reflecting each of the four archetypes.

These represent your individual results on each criteria and show how the four archetypes were selected. The outer ring represents highest and the inner ring the lowest.



THE TWELVE EPITOME ARCHETYPE ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

To assist in understanding the leadership criteria identified by the EAF assessment, below are the 12 questions you responded to when you completed the assessment. Each question had four statements and you ranked each statement from “fully describes me” to “does not describe me at all”.

Leading - What do you draw on to lead your team to deliver the optimum results?

Trust – What do you most trust when making decisions?

Constraints – What constrains you in work situations?

Inspiration – What inspires you in a senior leader?

Managing Challenges – How do you deal with challenges and setbacks?

Others View Me – How do work colleagues describe you?

Striving – What do you strive for in your role?

Working With Peers – How do you behave when working with your peers?

At Your Worst – How would you describe yourself when you are at your worst (under pressure/ bored/unhappy)?

Confidence – What gives you confidence when acting in a leadership role?

Power – How do you behave when working with your peers?

Ambition – How would you describe your relationship with ambition?

EPITOME

RESOURCES

CG Jung (1999) “Man and his Symbols”

Connie Zweig, Steven Wolf (2009).
“Romancing the Shadow: A Guide to
Soul Work for a Vital, Authentic Life”

Carol Pearson (2021) “What stories are you
living?”

Mary Dian Molton, Lucy Anne Sikes (2011)
Four Eternal Women: Toni Wolff Revisited

contact | merle@epitome-leadership.com